Coming Home

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/43949082.

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Teen And Up Audiences

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Melog (She-Ra)

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Coming Home

by Lyssandia

Summary

Adora shows Catra her room in Brightmoon for the first time. Neither of them are prepared for the things that awaits them.

Notes

This was planned as a scene for a longer work that now might never get written.
But this one was almost finished and I wanted to give it a try as my first fanfic in ages and also the first I've written in English.
Have fun!

Edit: Thanks to my amazing friend Altecfenix, my other ideas came to life and I really enjoy working with them!
This chapter will be included, although worked on. I'll leave this separate, since this is rated different.
For all who might be interested:
https://archiveofourown.org/works/44640118/chapters/112303654

See the end of the work for more notes

"So, this is it… my room!", Adora said, curious how Catra might react to it. "Our room now", she quickly corrected herself.

Bow just said goodbye to them after a long tour through Brightmoon Castle, showing Catra everything, now that she agreed to live here.

Glimmer had asked Catra if she wanted to have a small room for herself, or if she preferred to share with Adora and to her surprise, both girls had answered that they wanted to share. With a lot of blushes on both sides.

It was still a bit awkward, because they somehow were finally a couple now, but it was all very new and fresh and the years apart had been hard on both of them. And yet, they both wanted to be together.

"What are you waiting for, then? Show me already!", Catra said a bit impatient, her tail nervously swaying back and forth, giving away that she wasn't as calm as she wanted to appear.

They both blushed again, but Adora eventually opened the door and let her girlfriend in.

"Oh", she made when she immediately noticed some changes to it.

So that was the reason Glimmer vanished earlier, Adora thought and a warm feeling build up inside of her.

Instead of just one bed, there actually were two, put together and loaded with blankets and pillows. And on one of them was a note.

Welcome home, Catra

The feline needed a moment to take everything in. This room wasn't that different from any other rooms she saw in the castle, but it was bright and warm and in the air Adora's scent was everywhere.

When she too saw the bed and the note on it, she hold her breath for a second, not knowing what to say. But a small smile showed up on her face, revealing a tiny bit of her fang and Adora knew that Catra loved this.

"I have to admit", she quietly said with flattened ears, "I never thought I would actually like your friends. But fuck it, I do. They have every right to hate me, but still, they chose not to. And as awkward as this is, it feels… good."

"Catra…", whispered the blonde, wiping away a lonely tear from her eye, feeling relieved at her girlfriend's words.

Adora knew that the feline didn't need to lie around her. They were friends again, girlfriends even and apparently Catra had decided that she wanted to be more honest with Adora, sharing her thoughts.

A loud and happy meow suddenly interrupted Adora's pondering and she laughed when she saw a very happy Melog rolling up in a brand new basket for them next to the beds, apparently trying to find the ideal position for a nice cat-nap.

"Looks like Melog likes it!", Catra laughed, too.

Adora was so happy at this moment. She looked at her girlfriend and couldn't really believe that she truly was here! In her room! In Brightmoon!

It was a dream come true and she didn't even dared to believe it could be true one day - and yet, here she was, laughing, even.

It was so nice to see Catra laughing again. A sight Adora wanted to see a lot more now.

She knew it wouldn't be easy. They both had been through a lot. Catra struggled so much she could barely hide it and it hurt Adora to not be able to instantly fix this. She was aware that Catra would need a lot of time to heal - not only physically, but mentally as well. Hell, it would take them both time to realize how much

abuse they'd grown up with. It was hard to admit, but Adora was aware that the way she was treated by Shadow Weaver had been abusive and once she realized that, she also saw how bad it must've been for the feline as well.

But right now, she just wanted to be near Catra again, see her laughing like that and feel the happiness that came from having her best friend here.

"Is that waterfall for showering?", Catra curiously asked and Adora had to laugh again at that question, remembering that she asked the same when Glimmer showed her this room for the first time.

"No. That actually is just for decoration. It's stupid, I know! The bathroom is here!"

With some quick steps she walked over to another door and opened it and just loved how Catra's eyes got big.

"No way! That room is huge! There's no way this is just for one person!"

"Well, it's for two now. And Melog, if they want", said Adora, sending her girlfriend a smirk.

Again, Catra blushed a bit, but then she seemed to have a thought.

"Would you mind if I take a shower? I… smell gross."

"Go ahead, this is yours now, too. I'll wait here. Take your time."

Catra was actually right. They still wore the same clothes they already wore days ago and Adora was looking forward to having a shower as well. When Catra closed the door behind her, Adora sat down on her bed and looked at Melog, who laid in their basket, purring in their nap.

I think this is one the happiest days of my life.

Catra first went to the toilet, surprised at the softness the toilet paper had. Sitting there for a moment in peace, her gaze took in all the things that were in here, when she noticed something else. At the sink, there was a second toothbrush tumbler, together with a toothbrush and some toothpaste. Both specially made for people with fangs.

That's not true, is it? Is that really for me?

When she finished her business and got over to wash her hands, she even saw that the tumbler had a doodled cat's face on it.

It is for me!

It felt so weird. But in the same time, her chest felt warm.

The surprises didn't even stop there. When she washed her hands, she immediately noticed that the water from the tub was warm, too! She could even adjust it to a temperature she liked!

We should have had that in the Fright Zone!

Another thought striked her mind.

No way! Is the shower warm, too?

Catra had never been more eager to get into a shower than now!

Stripping her dirty and ripped clothes off she didn't even think about anything else.

Carefully she turned the tab on and tried some different angles on it - and indeed, the water coming from the shower head was warm! Almost too hot, really!

Oh stars, this is amazing!

The feline had hated water so much all her life, but right now the warm stream was able to sooth her sore muscles and she actually

felt a bit relaxed.

By the time she thought she should look for some soap her fingers were already more than a tiny bit shriveled.

That's when it hit her once again.

There's even shampoo for me.

She stared wide-eyed at the bottle whose label clearly said for short fur and hair.

Tears found their way down her cheeks and mixed with the still warm water, but this time, those tears weren't sad ones.

Catra couldn't really name it, but she felt indeed welcomed.

Thank you, Glimmer!, she thought, truly grateful for all those little signs the queen had left here for her.

How many times had she had doubts about even coming here? Daring to come to a place she once wanted to destroy?

Glimmer had made clear that they still needed to talk about things, but that she didn't hold any more grudges against her. That Catra was welcomed as long as she stayed true to the promise that she would never harm any member of the Rebellion again and she would work for her.

But also, Glimmer just made sure Catra would not feel rejected.

For the first time in her life, she felt truly welcomed.

Opening the bottle, she noticed that the shampoo didn't even have much of a smell. It was truly made for someone with a delicate nose.

She massaged a little bit of it's content into what was left of her mane, shutting out all the thoughts about how much she hated that short haircut and cleaned herself thoroughly.

Finally finished, the feline stepped out of the shower and grabbed one of the fluffiest towels she ever had.

It was only when she dryed herself up that she noticed that there weren't any clothes for her to wear.

Or so she thought, until she eventually noticed a small pile on one of the shelves with another note for her, this time with an apologizing doodle of Glimmer.

Sorry, Catra, I couldn't find something else in your size. I'll have something made for you as soon as I can, so please bear with this for a few hours. Glimmer

A growl left her mouth, when she took in what Glimmer had left for her.

Oh, come on.

It was a short, rosy silken nightgown. And lucky for her, some panties.

Snorting, she considered just wearing her old clothes again, but when she looked at that sad pile, she knew she didn't want to.

I can't believe I'm doing this!

When she finally left the bathroom, she felt very awkward. The nightgown was way shorter than she liked and although she had to admit she looked good in it, she didn't really want anyone to see her wearing such a thing.

That was, until she heard Adora.

"Oh, Catra, there you a…"

The blonde stopped mid-sentence and Catra could hear how she swallowed. Hard.

With cheeks red as tomatoes she barely wanted to look at Adora, but then she saw the way Adora looked at her, her face the same red as her own.

"Wow. You're so beautiful!", Adora said, not even noticing that she said it aloud.

Catra's face turned even darker, but somehow, she even felt a bit flustered now.

"Thanks", she lowly replied, and suddenly, she didn't hate this stupid nightgown anymore. Not when Adora looked at her like this.

Adora had another idea, then.

"Sit down", she instructed the feline, gesturing to a chair, and not knowing what Adora had in mind, she did.

It took Adora only half a minute to get what she wanted and when she reappeared from the bathroom, she held a hairbrush in her hand.

"I know you hated this when we were kids, but please, let me do this?"

Catra growled again at that sight.

Yes, she had indeed always hated it when someone tried to comb through her hair. Her mane had always been messy and wild and she had always taken pride in how untamed it made her look. Only when she changed into her new uniform she had made the effort of smoothing it down a bit more, noticing at that time that her tufts were gone, a sign that she was all grown up now, not longer a child.

But right now, her mane was gone, her hair shorter than it had ever been. Like someone had been able to finally tame her.

As if Adora had been able to guess what she thought, she felt the blonde's hand on her shoulder.

"It will grow back. It might take some time, but hair grows. And… when you let me, I will take care of it."

Usually, Catra would refuse.

But she had taken on the hidden plea in Adora's voice. Her need to do something for her. She couldn't fix anything this time, but she did want to do something.

And Catra didn't have it in herself to refuse that plea.

"Okay."

She could literally see how Adora's face lit up and was glad that she gave her permission.

"I'll be careful!", the blonde promised and started to work.

Thanks to the shampoo Catra had used earlier, her hair was easy to smooth down and Adora had no trouble at all brushing it. She seemed to be so happy that she even hummed doing it.

"You're purring!", the blonde pointed out a minute later.

What?

But Adora was right. Without her even noticing her larynx betrayed her.

Catra blushed again while her ears flattened.

"It's cute. I've always loved your purr."

"Oh", said Catra at this admission, feeling even more flustered again.

Eventually, Adora finished brushing and looked satisfied with her work.

"It's all smooth now."

When Catra looked at the mirror, she saw that her short hair looked more glossy than ever and it even appeared a tiny bit longer, now that all knots had been brushed out.

It's already a bit longer than… before…

"Thank you", she whispered and Adora nodded.

"You're welcome."

An awkward silence formed, none of them knew what to say, until Adora finally cleared her throat.

"I guess it's my time for a shower now. I'll be quick!"

When Adora entered the bathroom, she had to take some breaths.

How can she be this cute?, she thought.

Catra's purr had made more than clear how Catra felt. Adora knew all the different variations in her girlfriend's purr and the one she let out while Adora brushed her hair was the one she only ever had whenever they cuddled as kids, hidden under blankets, feeling safe and content.

Holy shit!, it hit her, when it finally clicked.

I have always been the only one she let hear that purr or even blinked at! Does that mean she loved me even back then? And she even showed me?

Catra had always tried to not let anyone else hear her purr (she failed at that when she fell asleep though) and she only ever told Adora what that blinking meant (at least she tried with how much it was just instinct).

But only now Adora realized how Catra had always shown her that she loved her in her own, peculiar ways!

I love you! I always have!

Those were the words Catra said to her to safe her.

And just now, Adora realized that her girlfriend even showed her every time.

I really am such an idiot!

She sighed, feeling stupid for a moment that she never noticed it before. But how could she have known?

Before Adora could spiral more into that thought, her eye caught on something different.

A second toothbrush?

She looked at the now used toothbrush, even taking in the new tumbler with the cat doodle on it and smiled.

Oh Glimmer! You really did something here!

Like Catra before her she also noticed the other toiletries her best friend brought here and felt the same grateful welcome.

Glimmer didn't have to do this. But she did anyway. Not only to welcome Catra, but also to show Adora that they would support her, no matter what.

You really are some amazing friends!

When she finally left the bathroom, refreshed and in her pyjamas, she wasn't prepared for the sight she would walk in to.

"Awww."

Catra laid on Adora's bed on top of the blanket, a bit curled into herself like she always used to do and was fast asleep.

Cautiously, Adora tiptoed over to her bed, taking the second blanket and covered her sleeping girlfriend carefully to not wake her up.

She knew how much trouble Catra had to fall asleep lately, always fearing that more nightmares might haunt her. That she was now able to finally find enough safety to give in to her need of sleep made Adora feel hopeful.

We will be better. It might take time, but we will!

She gave her sleeping girlfriend a little kiss on her head, before laying down herself next to her, always being careful not to wake her up.

Adora took in the sight before her one last time before falling asleep herself. The sight of her girlfriend next to her, in Brightmoon which she considered her home.

We're finally both home.

End Notes

Thanks for reading!
Please feel free to share your thoughts!

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!